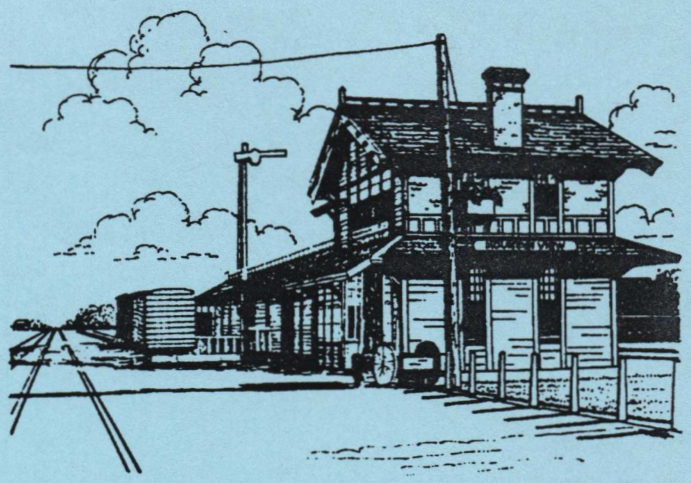
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Mountain View: Moving Forward Looking into the Past The February Meeting

The *Friends of the Mountain View Public Library* provided the funds, The *Mountain View Public Library* made available the resources, and *Mountain View Community Television (Channel 15)* provided the skills and direction to create an excellent video titled *Mountain View: Moving Forward, Looking into the Past*. You can check out a copy from the Library, or you can come see the video with the Historical Association at the February 3, 2002 regular meeting. The meeting will be at the *Adobe Building*, located on the North East corner of the intersection of Moffett Blvd. and the Central Expressway. The Producer/Director for the video, William Nielsen, from the staff at KMVT will be present. He is currently engaged in producing a video for the City, to support the Centennial Celebration, and he may want to solicit our help in that project. The Mountain View Video is very good. I feel sure that you will enjoy this look at our City.

Our meetings are an excellent opportunity to greet old friends and meet new ones. Our hospitality hostess, Elizabeth Engberg will oversee beverages and snacks at the end of the meeting.

Celebrating The Adobe The November Meeting

The November meeting was held at *The Adobe Building*, and was the culmination of a six year effort by the Historical Association to help the city preserve and restore this fine landmark building. The effort began in November, 1995 with an Historical Association Newsletter article *Save The Adobe Campaign Begins* by *Eva G. Mockbee*. It continued with circulating petitions, staffing booths at fairs, and providing public speakers. It was with great satisfaction that the Association was again able to hold a regular meeting in the beautifully restored facility.



Milestones: A History of Mountain View, California

BY MARY JO IGNOFFO

In early 1998, the Mountain View Historical Association commissioned Mary Jo Ignoffo to write a history of Mountain View, to be available in the Spring 0f 2002, to honor the City of Mountain View's Centennial. Ms Ignoffo is the Vice President of the *California History Center Foundation* and the author of several articles and local history books, one of the latest being *Gold Rush Politics: California's First Legislature.*

Milestones: A History of Mountain View, California is nearly ready for publication and distribution. It is filled with wonderful pictures of people and places in old Mountain View.

Details concerning publication will be available at our February meeting. In the mean time, an eight page extract is available in the December, 2001 issue of *The Californian.*



The Rengstorff House

In Commemoration

Anne R. Craik — A native of Portland, Oregon, born August 20, 1924, died November 10, 2001 in Los Altos Hills. Anne is survived by her daughter, Denise Williams and a son, James Craik. Shad one grand daughter, Alison. Her hobbies were Bridge, Decorating and Gardening. She worked as a Volunteer for the History Center in the Mountain View Library and was a Member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Tony Spily — A native of Cupertino, California, born April 9, 1918, died April 25, 2001 in Rocklin. California. He and his late wife, Ruth Whiting Spily were both graduates of the Mountain View Union High School. He is survived by three children, six grandchildren and four great grandchildren. He was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

William "Bill" Henderson — A native of Mountain View, California, died December 20, 2001 at age 79. Survived by his wife Eleanor Henderson of Los Altos, brother Ed Henderson of Sunnyvale, daughters Janice Gallagher of Los Gatos, Kathy Newell of Carmel Valley, Peggy Thompson of Sunnyvale and Judy deRegt of Carmel. Grandfather of 13 and great-grandfather of 3.

Past President of the Mountain View Chamber of Commerce. Member of the Board of Freeholders preparing a Charter for the City of Mountain View 1951-1952. Past District Chairman for the Mountain View Scouts, past Chairman of the Mountain View United Community Fund, Man of the Year Award 1955. A Veteran of WWII, he received the Distinguished Flying Cross for extraordinary achievement. He was a Life Member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

The Hoo Hoo House
by
Kathleen Lowe Owen

In August 1926, nearly ten years after being relocated from the Pan-Pacific International Exposition to the hills near Monte Vista, the Hoo Hoo House - a controversial bu t popular dance resort near Mountain View - was destroyed by a "fire of undetermined origin". Originally the Oregon Building at he PPIE in San Francisco, the Hoo Hoo House had been moved to Monte Vista when the exposition closed. The building was designed by Bernard Maybeck who also created the PPIE's Fine Arts Palace. It was considered unique in design; huge redwood slabs covered the exterior and the building was surrounded by several immense pillars made to represent giant redwoods.

The Hoo Hoo House had been the subject of discussion and censure in the Mountain View Register Leader as early as 1921. It was closed by the County of Santa Clara in 1924. At that time the Register Leader reported that "after many years of practically unrestricted license to do evil the notorious Hoo Hoo House at Monte Vista near Cupertino has had its county license as a resort revoked by the Board of County Supervisors". The closure was the result of various community complaints, including an investigation conducted by members of the Grange in Mountain View and several surrounding towns. The Grange committee complained that "vulgar conditions were prevailing, that liquor flowed as freely as in pre-Volstead days and that the requirements of a county ordinance on lighting were disregarded" by the owners of the Hoo Hoo House.

The owners petitioned the county for a new business license several times during 1925 before finally leasing the building to A.H. Oswald of Cupertino and James Wylie of Mountain View in early 1926. Just a few months before the fire Oswald and Wylie reopened the facility as the Peninsular Club. The Peninsular Club was considered a private social organization. Members could pay a $5.00 fee for a three month membership; they could then attend weekly dances at the club. A dance had been held at the club the evening of the fire but the owners said the dancers had gone and the building had been locked for at least 30 minutes before the fire was first noticed.

Old Newspaper Items
Compiled By
Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1901): The San Jose Mercury for December 22, 1901 carried a very interesting description of Mountain View. In 1902 the town was incorporated and next year there are many events planned to celebrate. This newspaper article gives a wonderful picture of what was here and some history of the area. We ran the first extract from this long article in the last Newsletter. We continue below, and more will follow in future issues.

A PROSPEROUS COMMUNITY
(continued from previous Newsletter)

The original Mountain View was located about a mile southwest of the present town on the old stage route from San Francisco to San Jose. A hotel was erected there in 1852 by James Campbell and gradually a few stores and business shops of several kinds appeared. A church was built in 1859, by which time quite a large community had been established. But with the advent of the railroad in 1864 conditions were changed. The road passed about a mile east of the town, which was left that distance away from the station, at which point a new village soon made its appearance, and the latter has developed into the thriving and progressive Mountain View of today. The old town, however, still has a hotel, a blacksmith shop and some few other business houses, and a number of handsome residences. The fine Odd Fellows building is at the old town, and near it is the public school, one of the largest and most efficient in the county. The two towns are connected by a broad and well-kept highway, with inviting gardens and orchards on either hand.

Many Orchard Homes

The growth of Mountain View has steadily followed the cutting up of the extensive grants and ranches by which it was formerly surrounded. It was found long ago that the valley lands in the vicinity, which year after year had been rewarding their owners with rich harvest of hay wheat and barley, were especially

adapted to the growth of apricots, peaches, prunes and other fruits and that in the foothills near by the wine grape flourished and produced vintages exceeding in quality and merit even the choicest productions of the valley vineyards. The demand for orchard and vine lands by the many who want to engage in fruit and wine growing, supplemented by prosperous San Francisco residents who wished to provide themselves country homes in the midst of attractive surroundings, necessitated the subdivision of large tracts of land into comparatively small parcels, and sone by one the grain fields of the Emerson, Murphy, Taaffe, Hale and other big ranches have been converted into orchards and vineyards of from five to five to forty acres or more, an on nearly every one of these small tracts a house has been erected, some of them unpretentious but neat and comfortable, and many others costly and with all the luxurious appointments that wealth can supply. The small orchards may be numbered in by the hundreds, while some idea of the extent of the fruit and vine holdings in the district may be imparted to the reader by mentioning those of D.L. Delmas, containing one hundred acres in fruit and four hundred in vineyard; Joseph Sladly, two hundred acres in orchard and vineyards; the John Snyder estate, more than one hundred acres of fruit and vines; B. Distel, one hundred acres in fruit and vineyard, J.C. Campbell, one hundred and thirty acres in fruit and vines; R.C. Kirkwood, one hundred acres in orchard; G.P. Sparks, forty-two acres in orchard; Mrs. Benjamin Bubb, forty acres in fruit; Mrs. J. Abbott, forty acres in vineyard and orchard; Mrs. J. Bergin, one hundred acres in vines and fruit; E.W. Knapp, forty-five acres in orchard; James A. Huff, seventy-five acres in fruit; Mrs F.M. Ehrhorn, fifty acres in orchard, and many others might be mentioned. The growers as a rule dry their own fruit for the market, but there are several driers in the district where the fruit or orchardists who have no private driers is handled and prepared for shipment. The large number of vineyards in the district implies that there must be wineries, and such is the fact. Including the contiguous districts of Cupertino, the West Side country and Montebello, which is picturesquely located far up on the mountain side, and tributary to Mountain View, there are probably not less than twenty wineries in what may be called the _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (—unreadable words—).

(Continued in the next Newsletter)

75 Years Ago (1927): A manual arts building has been completed for the high school.

Mrs. Ruckdashel, lady barber formerly employed by Mr. Davidson, has opened her own shop at 1570 Villa Street.

The Sunshine Grocery at 172 Castro Street is now a Purity Grocery and advertised Old Dutch Cleanser at 3 cans for 19¢ and Oval Sardines at 10¢. Charles Milani opened the New Italian Grocery at 341 Castro Street.

Within one month the local Farmers and Merchants National Bank became Liberty Bank of America and then Bank of Italy.

E.E. Mylrea and Fred Greenough have leased the new service station being built for L. Arreco at the corner of Castro and California Streets.

Twenty-seven Chinese, Japanese and Filipinos were arrested on a Saturday night for gambling at 200 View Street. Police marched them to city hall and called in the Justice of Peace. The men pleaded guilty, posted bail and a trial date was set for the next week.

50 Years Ago (1952): Miss Helen Froelich, vocal and choral instructor at the high school, was named *Citizen of the Year 1951* by the Chamber of Commerce.

Sam Galvan was elected President of Sociedad Cervantes Lodge in place of retiring Joe Diaz.

Giant search lights were to light up the Chamber of Commerce building and the Methodist Church bell would ring to kick off the "March of Dimes" evening collection for polio funds. Parent and Teacher Association members, under leadership of Mrs. L.R. Forner and Mrs. Warren Grass, will go to homes where residents have turned on porch lights and hope to collect $900.

Voters have approved, 664 to 114, adoption of the Mountain View Charter, outlining a Council-City Manager type of government to become effective in April.

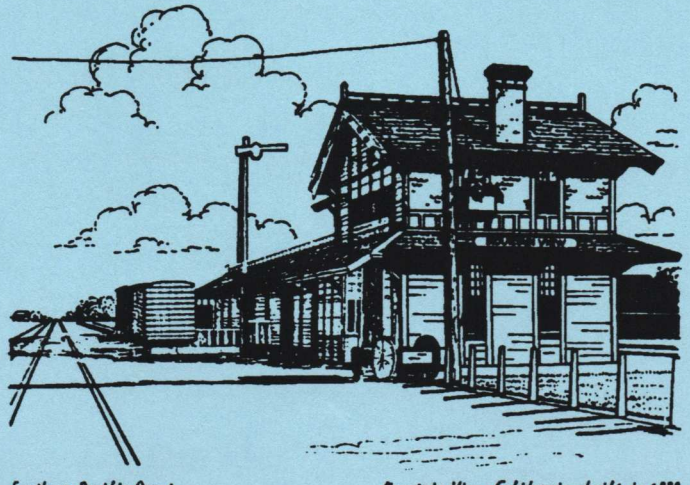
Honored for heroism in Korea were Lt. Ambrose Mena and First Lt. Henry J. Nafao.

A report from the State Engineer predicts that most Santa Clara county orchards and farmlands will be replaced by homes and industries. The local Chamber of Commerce urged the city to annex large parcels of land for industries, including parts of the Whisman School District and the triangle bounded by Whisman Road, Alviso Road and Bayshore Highway.

Editor's Musing
Hilton Brown

My wife and I have lived in Mountain View twenty one years, this month. When our employer moved us from New York to the Bay Area and we started looking for a home, we found Mountain View the perfect spot: good schools, parks, multi-ethnic, quiet streets, a fine library, respected public safety organizations, and an open and accessible city government. We made an excellent choice when we picked Mountain View.Some of the things that still delight us are the children playing soccer in the street in front of our house, the delightful little mini-park within easy walking distance where we can watch little ones sliding on slides, getting sandy in the sandbox and swinging on swings. We like this town that is large enough to pave and light the streets, collect the trash and provide excellent fire and safety services, but at the same time is small enough so that we know and can reach our elected officials and department heads.

Over the years the Mountain View Historical Association has been positive force in the community. We have supported the schools and the library, and we have been outspoken in preserving the best of our heritage. I'm glad I live here, and I'm glad that I have been given this opportunity to serve the Association.



Southern Pacific Depot *Mountain View, California, built in 1888*

Treasurer's Report
Hilton Brown

The financial status of the Mountain View Historical Association is presented in the tables to the right and below. Primary sources of revenue for the Association are: Annual Dues which arrive in the fourth quarter and first quarter of the following year, and net income from special events such as the Small Brewers Festival and the Annual Barbecue, Life Memberships, Merchandise Sales, and Donations. An important additional source is major grants such as the Arrillaga and Peery Foundations' grants to support publication of the History of Mountain View. Interest earned on the Association's CDs is credited on maturity. CDs are usually rolled over upon maturity.

This quarter there was $ 1,540.60 revenue collected but not deposited during the quarter and $ 518.27 in invoices received but not paid. These items will be properly accounted for in next quarters accounting.

Income & Expense
Oct. 1, 2001 - Dec. 31, 2001

Opening Balance - 10/1/01		$ 65,799.28
Income		
Annual Dues	$ 99.00	
Interest	620.27	
2001 Barbecue	1,095.00	
Merchandise Sales	60.50	
Cash Donations	75.00	
Total Income		1,949.97
Expense		
Bank Charges	$ 14.00	
Solicitation	235.62	
Membership	135.00	
Newsletter	306.95	
Adobe Fund	328.59	
Total Expense		1,020.16
Ending Balance - 12/31/01		$ 66,729.09

Disposition of Funds
December 31, 2001

Bank of Los Altos Checking	$ 12,173.97
Petty Cash	100.00
Bank of Los Altos CDs	54,098.12
Total Disposition - 12/31/2001	$ 66,729.09

Fund Balances
Sep. 30, 2001 & Dec. 31, 2001

Fund	9/30/01	12/31/01	Change
Adobe	887.73	559.14	-328.59
Life Member	7,848.00	7,687.00	-161.00
Memorial	744.14	744.14	0.00
Publication	50,000.00	50,000.00	0.00
Oper. Reserve	3,000.00	3,000.00	0.00
Payables	2,031.25	2,031.25	0.00
Equity	1,288.16	2,707.56	1,419.40
Total Funds	65,799.28	66,729.09	929.81

Help! Help!

The mail to the following members has been returned. Can you help with current addresses?

Juanita M. Camp
H. Lee Stillens
Patricia J. Reyburn
Hal J. Zangari
Richard M. Smith

Membership Report
June Casey

Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $ 10.00 per year for a family membership. Life memberships are available for $100.00 per person.

Life Members	97
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Annual Memberships	191
Total Memberships	290

New Members
- Tony & Antoinette Horrillo
- Mary Haines

Change to Life Members
- Laura A. Gentry
- Marlee G. Puppo
- Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
- Jane Culver Stoecklin

Association Officers And Executive Committee

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Craig Holden
Sergeant At Arms	John Viscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer & Editor	Hilton Brown
Membership	June Casey
Programs and Publicity	Liz & Mario Ambra
Hospitality	Elizabeth Engberg
Memorial/Remembrance	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Pat Figueroa
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting.

Life, Honored and Special Members

Honored Member

Chris Castro

Special Member

Lena Alameda

Life Members

O. Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
May E. Armanini
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Flora T. Brown
Hilton U. Brown, III
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June Redwine de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace J. Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carol Fischer
Tom Frankum
Laura A. Gentry
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Edward Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Audrey Jarvis Hoke
Alice Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
John P. Puppo
Marlee G. Puppo
Louis F. Renner
Patricia J. Reyburn
Mark Rogge
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
Brigitte Stafford
J. R. Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Jane Culver Stoecklin
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
H. (Hip) A. Telmont
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissel
Lorraine A. Wormald
Mary Lou Zoglin

Mountain View Historical Association

Regular Meeting

Mountain View: A Video Presentation

Sunday
February 3, 2002
2:00 P.M.
The Adobe Building

N.E. Corner of Moffett Blvd and Central Expressway

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____
Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042



FIRST CLASS MAIL

